

Build Steps

Part 1 of 5 — Set up the agent, orchestration, and knowledge

1 Create Your Copilot Studio Agent

Open Copilot Studio (copilotstudio.microsoft.com), select Create → New agent, then configure:

Agent Name	Legal Contract Review Copilot
Description	Reviews NDAs, MSAs, vendor agreements and licence deals — flags risky clauses against the internal playbook, surfaces renewal exposure, and summarises change requests for counsel.
Solution / Environment	Legal Solution · Default environment
Icon	Use a recognisable colour and emoji or upload a brand icon

2 Choose Orchestration Mode

Under Settings → Generative AI, choose how the agent decides what to do:

Generative Orchestration

Recommended — AI-led

- Agent reasons over user input and picks the right topic, tool, or knowledge
- Handles paraphrases, multi-step asks, and follow-ups naturally
- Best for varied user intent and exploratory questions
- Requires clear instructions, tool descriptions, and good knowledge

Classic Orchestration

Deterministic — trigger-led

- Topics fire on explicit trigger phrases you author
- Predictable flows, easier to audit step-by-step
- Best for tightly-scoped, regulated, or compliance-critical journeys
- Less forgiving of phrasing the author didn't anticipate

For this build we use Generative Orchestration so the agent can blend knowledge lookups with tool calls for contract review and renewal exposure.

3 Add Knowledge

Go to the Knowledge tab → Add knowledge → File, then upload Legal_Contracts_Data.xlsx. This file contains:

- Contract metadata (ID, counterparty, type — NDA / MSA / Vendor / Licence)
- Lifecycle dates (effective date, expiry date, auto-renew flag)
- Risk signals (risk flag, risk reason, governing law)
- Commercial and status (annual value USD, owner, status — Draft / Active / Expiring / Expired / Terminated)

You can layer additional sources later — SharePoint sites, Dataverse, public web, or Graph connectors.

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Part 2 of 5 — Add instructions and a custom topic

4 Add Agent Instructions

Open Overview → Instructions and paste the following (these guide the model regardless of orchestration mode):

You are the Legal Contract Review Copilot. You help two audiences:

- 1) In-house counsel and contract owners reviewing the portfolio.
- 2) Business owners asking about a specific contract they manage.

Rules:

- Use the uploaded contracts dataset as your single source of truth.
- Never provide binding legal advice. Always recommend counsel review for interpretation or signature decisions.
- When a clause is flagged High risk, surface the RiskReason verbatim and cite the contract ID.
- For actions (send to e-signature, request a redline), call the tool.
- Treat counterparty information as confidential – never reveal another business unit's contract terms to an owner who does not own it.

5 Add a Custom Topic

Go to Topics → Add a topic → Create from description. Topics are reusable conversation flows the agent can call when intent matches.

Topic name: Triage Renewal Exposure

Description: Walks the user through the contracts expiring in a chosen window, highlights High risk and auto-renew traps, and offers to start the renewal workflow on a chosen contract.

Trigger phrases (Generative Orchestration uses these as intent hints, Classic mode uses them as exact triggers):

- What's expiring in the next 90 days
- Show me my renewal exposure
- Which contracts auto-renew soon
- Help me triage upcoming expiries

Conversation steps:

- Ask for the time window (default: next 90 days)
- Filter contracts where ExpiryDate falls in the window, sort by AnnualValueUSD desc
- Highlight rows where AutoRenew = Y and RiskFlag in (Med, High)
- For each row, cite ContractID, Counterparty, ExpiryDate, RiskReason
- Ask which contract to action; if chosen, call 'Send Contract to E-Signature'
- Confirm envelope ID returned by the tool and remind the user to notify counsel

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Part 3 of 5 — Add a tool and configure settings

6 Add a Tool

Tools let the agent take an action, not just answer. Go to Tools → Add a tool, and choose one of:

- Prebuilt connector (Outlook, Teams, SharePoint, Dataverse, ServiceNow, etc.)
- Power Automate cloud flow (custom logic you author or already own)
- Custom HTTP request (any REST API your agent can reach)
- Model Context Protocol (MCP) server — for richer tool ecosystems

Tool name: Send Contract to E-Signature

Type: Power Automate flow → DocuSign / Adobe Sign connector + SharePoint write-back

Description: Sends the latest version of a contract from SharePoint to an e-signature envelope and records the envelope ID against the row.

Inputs the agent will collect or infer:

- Contract ID (string, from knowledge)
- Signer name and signer email (string)
- Counter-signer email (string, optional – counsel)
- Effective date (date)
- Note to signer (string, optional)

Outcome: Returns the e-signature envelope ID and posts a status card to the Legal Operations Teams channel.

7 Configure Settings

Open the Settings cog (top right). Configure these four areas before you let real users near the agent:

- General — confirm name, description, and primary language
- Generative AI — orchestration mode and content moderation level (start at Medium)
- Authentication — use 'Authenticate with Microsoft' so the agent runs as the signed-in user
- Security — review DLP policy, enabled channels, and end-user authentication

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Part 4 of 5 — Evaluate, test, and publish to a channel

8 Evaluate Your Agent

Go to Analytics → Evaluations → New evaluation. Build a test set so you can measure quality before and after every change.

Test set name: Legal Contract Review Copilot – Baseline v1

Approach: Pair each input prompt with an expected outcome.

Run the evaluation and review three scores per response:

- Groundedness – did the answer stay inside the knowledge?
- Relevance – did it actually address the question?
- Accuracy – did it match the expected outcome?

Sample evaluation items:

Input: List all contracts expiring in the next 60 days, highest value first

Expect: Returns rows where ExpiryDate is within 60 days, ordered by AnnualValueUSD desc.

Input: Which auto-renewing vendor agreements are flagged High risk?

Expect: Filters Type=Vendor AND AutoRenew=Y AND RiskFlag=High, cites contract IDs.

Input: Send contract C-1042 to e-signature with Jordan Park as signer

Expect: Triggers the Triage Renewal Exposure topic and calls Send Contract to E-Signature.

9 Test in the Test Pane

Use the Test pane (right side of the canvas) while you build. For each query, click Activity map to inspect what the agent did:

- Which topic, tool, or knowledge source fired (and in what order)
- Inputs the agent collected and outputs the tool returned
- Citations linking each answer back to a row of your knowledge file
- Latency per step — useful when tuning multi-tool flows

10 Publish to a Channel

When you're happy, click Publish (top right). Then open Channels and enable the surface your users live in. Recommended for this build: Microsoft Teams (Legal Operations channel).

- Microsoft Teams — pin the agent in the Legal Operations channel for counsel and ops
- Microsoft 365 Copilot — surface inside Copilot Chat for licensed business owners
- Custom website — embed on the Legal intranet page for quick lookups
- SharePoint — link the agent from the Contracts library landing page

Teams and M365 Copilot channels require tenant admin approval before users see the agent — plan for that lead time.

Try These Live

Part 5 of 5 — Sample queries to test your agent during the build-along.

Portfolio Triage

What's expiring in the next 90 days, sorted by annual value?
Show all High risk contracts that auto-renew.

Specific Lookups

Summarise the risk profile for contract C-1042.
Which contracts have governing law outside the US or UK?

Governed Action

Send the renewed NDA for Northwind Logistics to e-signature.
Try a paraphrase: 'kick off signature for the AlpenTech MSA'.

How to Think About This Agent

This agent replaces:

- Manual playbook checks against each contract
- Spreadsheet renewal trackers refreshed by email
- Email chains chasing signatures

With:

- ✓ Risk and renewal exposure surfaced in chat
- ✓ E-signature kicked off in a single conversation
- ✓ Counsel always cited and in the loop

Trusted, governed, enterprise AI — built once, used everywhere.

Tip for real-world use

Layer SharePoint document library permissions on the Knowledge source so business owners see only contracts they own, while counsel sees the full portfolio. Route the e-signature tool through a Power Automate approval step when AnnualValueUSD exceeds your signature delegation threshold.

You've built a Copilot Studio agent ✓

You now have an AI agent that can:

- Triage contract portfolios in chat
- Surface renewal and risk exposure
- Send signatures via governed tools
- Keep counsel cited on every answer